



7 Best Practices For Securing The Public Cloud

The author explains the seven most important steps in securing the public cloud that every organisation can follow



Harish Chib
is vice president
- Middle East and
Africa, Sophos

The simplicity and cost-effectiveness of the public cloud have lead more and more organisations to take advantage of Amazon Web Services (AWS), Microsoft Azure and Google Cloud Platform (GCP). You can spin up a new instance in minutes, scale resources up and down whenever you need while only paying for what you use, and avoid high upfront hardware costs.

While the public cloud solves many traditional IT resourcing challenges, it does introduce new headaches. Rapid growth of cloud usage has resulted in a fractured distribution of data, with workloads spread across disparate instances and, for some organisations, platforms. As a result, keeping track of data, workloads and architecture changes in those environments to keep everything secure

is often a highly challenging task.

Public cloud providers are responsible for security of the cloud (physical data centres, and separation of customer environments and data). However, responsibility for securing workloads and data placed in the cloud lies firmly with the customers. Just as organisations need to secure the data stored in their on-premises networks, they also need to secure their cloud environment. Misunderstandings around this distribution of ownership are widespread, and resulting security gaps have made cloud-based workloads the new pot of gold for today's savvy hackers.

Seven steps to securing the public cloud

The secret to effective cybersecurity in the cloud is improving the overall security pos-